

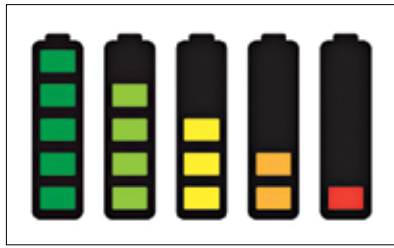
On the left, you will see the 'Core parking index' slider which should be at 100% if you want all your cores to be unparked. Hit Apply and you're good to go.

68 Use smart power profiles

Although unparking all your CPU cores won't be a problem for desktop PCs, it will be terrible for laptops since it will drain away the battery quickly. One workaround will require you to park and unpark the CPUs when you're using an intensive software or running a CPU intensive game. However, this requires too much work. A better solution would be using a good CPU utility called Process Lasso (bitsum.com). This utility software consists of an endless number of features to automate and optimise your system performance. You could say that it's the task manager on multiple steroids. It has an additional power plan called Bitsum Highest Performance that unparks all your CPU cores and doesn't allow the CPU frequency to fall below the base clock. After enabling, head over to **Settings > System > Power & Sleep > Additional power settings** and ensure that **Bitsum Highest Performance** is selected. We are more interested in the feature that allows you to assign power profiles to specific applications. Essentially, rather than keeping the intensive power plan active throughout, assigning an application with the higher power plan will ensure that it's active only when the application is running. Launch Process Lasso, right-click on the application to which you want to assign the power plan then go to **Applications power profile > Bitsum Highest Performance**.

69 Tweaking advanced power settings

Apart from the three preset power options, there are several other advanced options that can be tweaked. Head over to **Settings > System > Power & sleep > Additional power settings**. You'll come across all the preset power plans here. Beside those plans, click on 'Change plan settings' and then 'Change advanced power settings'. Several options will be listed that will allow you to control the power management to various components in your system. Under 'Hard disk', enter 'O' under 'Setting' that will



ensure your hard drive doesn't turn off when idle. In 'Wireless Adapter Settings', select 'Maximum Performance' and your wireless adapter won't go to sleep. If your system is using an Intel CPU with an IGP and not using a discrete graphics card, then you should select 'Maximum performance' under 'Intel Graphics Settings'. 'Link State Power Management' in 'PCI Express' puts your PCI-e components to a low power mode and if you want the least latency when they wake up, change the setting to 'Off'. 'Processor power management' looks after your processor's state and in order for it to run with maximum performance, turn up both the minimum and maximum processor state to 100%. Do note, ramping up these settings are going to draw in a lot of power, so if you're using a laptop, your battery will drain sooner.

70 Silent mechanical keyboards

Mechanical keyboards are extremely durable to membrane keyboards but they do come at a cost and can get quite loud at times of rigorous typing. Although there are mechanical switch variants that are comparatively more silent, they are still noisy in a quiet environment. If you want to tone things down, you can install O-rings under your keycaps. Available on Amazon and Flipkart (and sometimes cheaper on Aliexpress and Banggood),



you can buy a bag of O-rings for all your keys. Make sure you're buying the appropriate number of O-rings. All you need to do is remove the keycaps with a keycap puller and insert the O-rings individually around the stem of the keycap underneath. Install the keycap back and you'll notice a considerable reduction in the noise of pressing the keys.

71 DIY power supply cable sleeving

Cable management inside your PC case is important not just for aesthetics but if it's too messy, it will affect the airflow inside and sometimes even lead to loose connections. Buying an expensive PSU will ensure that the cables are sleeved so that individual wires don't hang around loose. However, if you're buying one in the lower budget segment, it's highly likely that you're going to get the ketchup and mustard mix. To tidy things up, you can buy cable sleeving kits. You have to ensure the right diameter of the sleeve you use for different cables. If you wish, you can also combine multiple cables of different components in one sleeve. Along with the sleeving kit, you will need a handful of other tools to cut and insert the cables inside the sleeves and a heat gun or even a lighter if you're going to seal down the sleeves. Hence, you will have to follow the instructions step by step since accidentally cutting off any cable could be irreparable. Cable sleeving isn't restricted to only the power supply but any device with cables. It could also be done for your keyboard and mouse.

Want more?

Tips like these are among the most requested content in feedback that we receive from our readers, which is why we dedicated an entire cover story to them. We hope that we have covered a wide range of use cases. If these were not enough for you or if you're interested in anything specific, drop us an email at editor@digit.in and you just might see it in the next issue! 📧